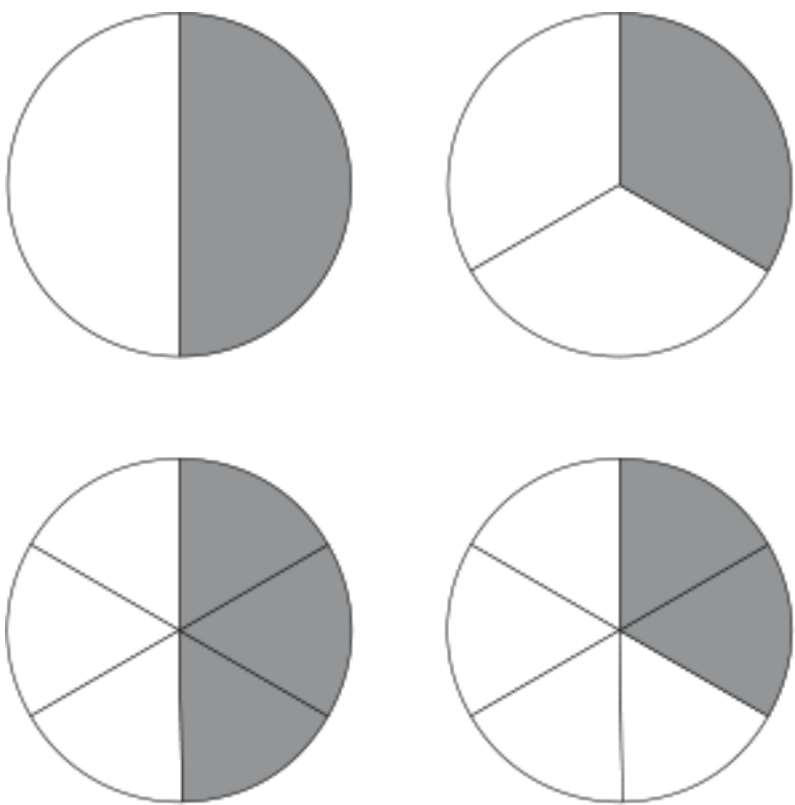


Imagine trying to add $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{1}{3}$. The circles are cut into sections of different sizes, so there isn't a way to combine them.

Here the circles are cut into sixths. $\frac{1}{2}$ becomes $\frac{3}{6}$. $\frac{1}{3}$ becomes $\frac{2}{6}$.

Now you can add: $\frac{3}{6} + \frac{2}{6} = \frac{5}{6}$

Hide

Find a common denominator for $\frac{3}{4}$ and $\frac{1}{6}$, and write equivalent fractions.

$$4 \times 6 = 24$$
$$\frac{3}{4} \times \frac{6}{6} = \frac{18}{24} \quad \rightarrow \quad \text{to add,} \quad \frac{18+4}{24} = \frac{22}{24}$$

$$\frac{1}{6} \times \frac{4}{4} = \frac{4}{24} \quad \rightarrow \quad = \frac{11}{12}$$

The best way to find a common denominator is to find the **least common multiple (LCM)** for both denominators.

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Find a common denominator for $\frac{3}{4}$ and $\frac{1}{6}$, and write equivalent fractions.

4: 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, ...

6: 6, 12, 18, 24, ...

The lowest number in both lists is 12.

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} \frac{3}{4} \times \frac{3}{3} = \frac{9}{12} \\ \frac{1}{6} \times \frac{2}{2} = \frac{2}{12} \end{array} \right\} \text{ add: } \frac{9+2}{12} = \frac{11}{12}$$

Rate Your Confidence

^ High

= Medium

Low

Category

Lesson 4: Fraction Basics

 Related Questions:
[Practice questions taken related to this topic](#)